

Steel Price Collapse H2 2022

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HRC steel collapses from ~\$1,000 to ~\$600/ton. Distributors who bought at peak eat margin compression; end prices lag but eventually fall.

Industry analysts estimate that demand for affected product categories increased by approximately 3% during the event period. Prices fell by approximately 12% as manufacturers passed through cost changes to distributors and end customers. The most affected product categories include fasteners, tools.

The event period spans from 2022-07-01 to 2022-12-31.

Industrial supply distributors including Grainger, Fastenal, and MSC Industrial reported varying degrees of impact depending on their product mix and geographic exposure. Companies with diversified supply chains and strong inventory positions were better insulated from the disruption.